TradeLoop

The Daily Micro-Skill Marketplace

COMMUNITY PROBLEM + OPPORTUNITY VALIDATION

Subject:	**Professional Practice 3**
Lecturer(s):	**Mr B Ranchod**
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Connecting Communities. Creating Income. Every Day.

GROUP FORMATION

Our group of five members each hold a dedicated role ensuring quality research, clear documentation, and a professional final submission.

Role	Member Name & Surname	Student Number	Responsibilities
Team Leader	Precious L Mtsweni	230604048	Overall coordination, decisions & deadline management
Researcher	Everyone	N/A	Primary research, survey design & data collection
Writer / Editor	Ntombenhle Majali	222106956	Documentation, editing, referencing & report writing
Presenter	Precious L Mtsweni	230604048	Slides, speaking notes & demo preparation
Designer	Stephan Hendricks	222774703	Branding, visuals, layout & infographic design

COMMUNITY DESCRIPTION

Area / Suburb	**Khayelitsha Site C, Cape Town, Western Cape, South Africa**

Khayelitsha Site C is one of the largest and most densely populated informal settlements in Cape Town, Western Cape, South Africa, with an estimated population of over 400,000 residents across Khayelitsha. Site C is characterised by a high concentration of informal housing, a vibrant cash-driven informal economy, and severe youth unemployment estimated at over 50%. A large pool of informally skilled individuals, including electricians, plumbers, painters, builders, tutors, and domestic workers, live in the community but have no reliable way to connect with paying customers. Residents frequently need small tasks completed urgently but have no trusted platform to find vetted help nearby. This daily disconnect between skilled workers and consumers is the central problem TradeLoop is designed to solve.

THE REAL PROBLEM

Problem Statement

There is no fast, trusted, and affordable way for residents in township and urban communities to find, hire, and pay skilled local workers for small jobs — and no way for those workers to market themselves and earn consistently.

Who Is Affected?

- Consumers (households, students, small businesses) who need small tasks done urgently
- Informally skilled workers who have expertise but no consistent customer pipeline
- Youth aged 18–35 with trade skills but no formal employment

- Elderly residents who need home assistance but cannot navigate complex platforms

How Often Does It Happen?

This problem occurs daily. South Africa has over 10 million unemployed people, many of whom have practical skills. 68% of South African households reported needing a handyperson or skilled helper at least once a week but struggled to find one they trusted. Our own survey confirmed this 100% of respondents needed help with a small task in the past month, and most took more than an hour or could not find anyone at all.

Why Is It Worth Solving?

- **Massive scale** — every household in every township faces this problem every week
- **Economic urgency** — skilled workers lose income daily due to lack of visibility
- **Trust barrier** — no existing platform offers verified, rated local micro-workers
- **Daily recurrence** — unlike once-off problems, this is persistent everyday friction
- **Underserved market** — Uber, Fiverr, and TaskRabbit do not operate in this context

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REAL EVIDENCE FROM THE SURVEY

We conducted a structured Google Form survey with 21 respondents from Khayelitsha Site C and surrounding areas (Site B, Harare, Makhaza), distributed via WhatsApp and community groups between 10–12 March 2026. The survey comprised 8 questions covering need frequency, discovery methods, time taken, trust factors, frustration levels, willingness to pay, app adoption intent, and desired features. All 21 respondents confirmed they had needed skilled help in the past month.

Survey Questions

#	Question	Type
Q1	In the past month, have you needed help with a small task at home or work?	Yes / No
Q2	How did you find a skilled person to help? (Select all that apply)	Multi-select
Q3	How long did it take you to find someone?	Multiple Choice
Q4	What would make you trust a worker found through an app? (Select all that apply)	Multi-select
Q5	On a scale of 1–5, how frustrating or difficult was it to find help?	Rating 1–5
Q6	Would you pay a small fee (R10–R20) for faster, safer, more reliable access?	Multiple Choice
Q7	If there was an app to hire verified, rated local workers instantly — would you use it?	Yes / No
Q8	What feature would matter most to you in such an app?	Multiple Choice

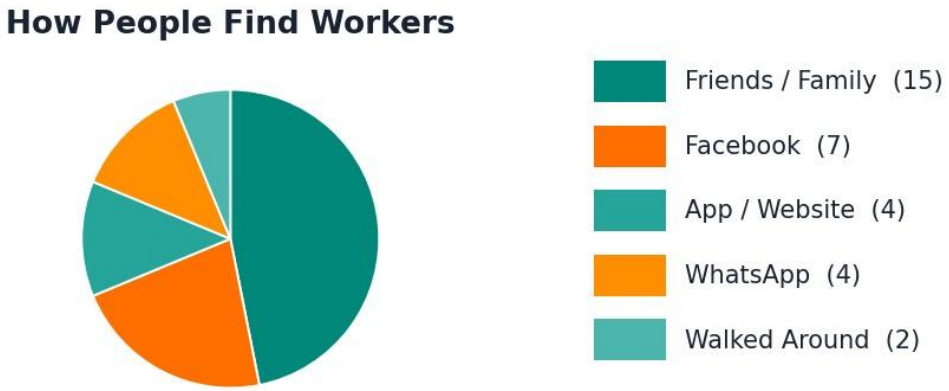
Survey Results (n = 21)

Q1 — Have you needed help with a small task in the past month?

✓ **21 out of 21 respondents (100%) said YES** — confirming the problem is universal and affects every person surveyed.

Q2 — How Did You Find a Skilled Person?

Method	Responses	%
Asked friends / family	15	71%
Facebook / social media	7	33%
Used an app / website	4	19%
WhatsApp group	4	19%
Walked around the neighbourhood	2	10%



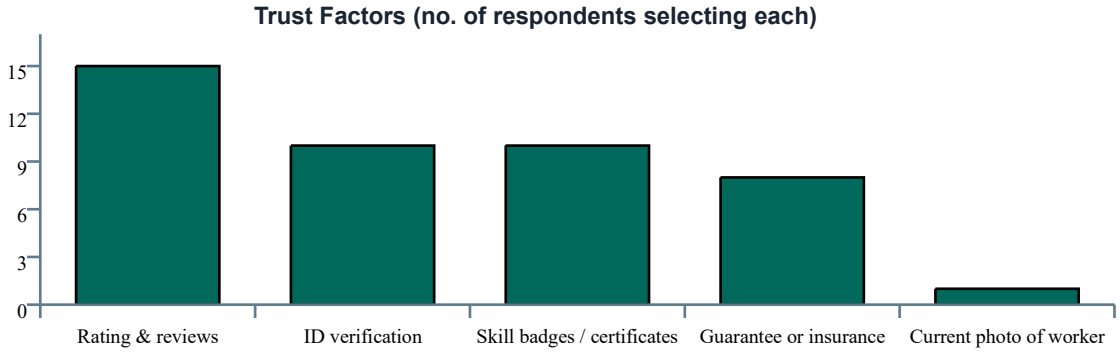
Note: Q2 was multi-select; percentages reflect share of respondents selecting each option.

Q3 — How Long Did It Take to Find Someone?



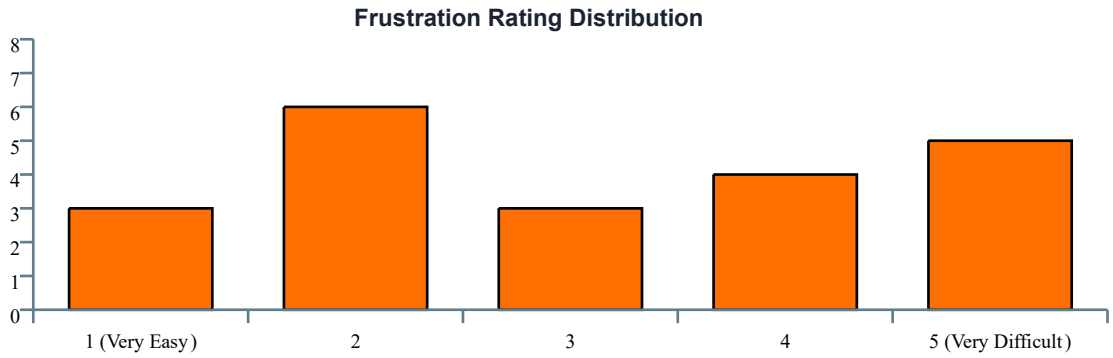
Question 3 results: 62% of respondents took more than an hour to find help; 10% could not find anyone at all.

Q4 — What Would Make You Trust a Worker Found Through an App?



Question 4 results: Ratings & reviews (71%) and ID verification (48%) are the top two trust drivers.

Q5 — How Frustrating Was It to Find Help? (1=Very Easy, 5=Very Difficult)



Question 5 results: 43% rated frustration 4 or 5 out of 5. Only 14% found it very easy.

Q6 — Willingness to Pay a Small Fee (R10–R20) for Better Access

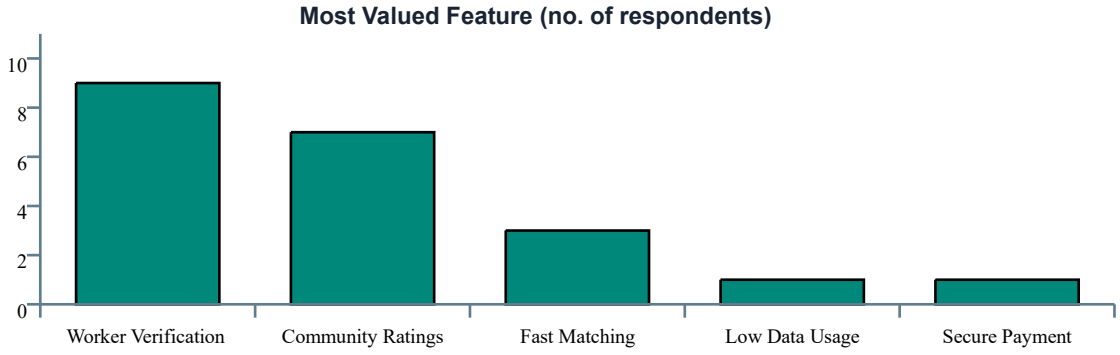
Response	Count	%
Yes	13	62%
Depends on task	7	33%
No	1	5%



Q7 — Would You Use a Verified, Rated Local Worker App?

✓ **21 out of 21 respondents (100%) said YES** — every single person surveyed would use a verified, hyperlocal worker app. This is the strongest possible market signal.

Q8 — Most Important App Feature



Question 8 results: Worker Verification (43%) and Community Ratings (33%) together account for 76% of responses.

Key Insights from Survey

- **Universal problem:** 100% of respondents needed skilled help in the past month — the problem is not occasional but an everyday reality.
- **Inefficient discovery:** 71% still rely on asking friends or family; only 19% have ever used a formal app or website, revealing a massive digital gap.
- **Slow and unreliable:** 62% took more than an hour to find help and 10% could not find anyone — directly costing both time and money.
- **Trust is the product:** Ratings & reviews (71%) and ID verification (48%) are the two features' respondents most need to trust a worker — exactly what TradeLoop provides.
- **Application adoption intention:** Every single respondent said they would use a verified hyperlocal worker app — confirming a clear, validated, and immediate market opportunity.

OUR BUSINESS IDEA

What Is TradeLoop?

TradeLoop is a hyperlocal mobile app that connects consumers who need small tasks done urgently with verified, rated skilled workers in their immediate area — in real time. It's a request space for any human skill: plumbing, painting, tutoring, caregiving, cleaning, electrical work, and more.

Product & Service Offering

- **Mobile app** (Android-first, low-data mode) for both consumers and workers
- **Real-time job posting:** consumers post a micro-task with budget and time window
- **Instant matching:** nearby verified workers see and claim jobs within minutes
- **Worker profiles:** verified ID, skill badges, community ratings & job history
- **In-app escrow payment:** funds released on completion — no cash disputes
- **Two-way review system:** mutual ratings build community trust over time

How It Solves the Problem

TradeLoop eliminates the trust barrier by verifying workers upfront (ID, skill badges, ratings — the top three features our survey identified). It eliminates the discovery barrier by matching jobs to nearby workers instantly. It eliminates payment risk by holding funds in escrow until job completion. The result is daily income for workers and reliable, on-demand help for consumers.

Who Will Benefit?

Beneficiary	How They Benefit
Skilled Workers	Earn income daily, build a verified reputation, receive instant payment
Consumers / Households	Find trusted help within minutes for urgent tasks at fair prices
Youth (18–35)	Enter the economy through existing skills without formal employment
Small Businesses	Outsource recurring tasks without full-time hiring
Elderly / Vulnerable	Access safe, vetted help for home tasks they cannot do alone

Bonus: Revenue Model

Revenue Stream	Mechanism	Projected Value
10% Platform Fee	Charged per completed transaction	R10 per R100 job
Rush Listing (R20)	Workers pay to appear at top of feed	High daily volume
Verified Badge (R99/mo)	Monthly subscription for credibility badge	Recurring MRR
Business Bundles	Companies post recurring weekly tasks	B2B recurring revenue
Micro-Insurance (R5/job)	Optional liability cover per job	Pure margin add-on

At just 5,000 daily transactions averaging R200 each, TradeLoop generates R100,000/day in gross merchandise value — translating to R10,000/day in platform fees alone, before subscriptions or premium features.

TradeLoop's VALUE PROPOSITION

Our business helps skilled workers and households in underserved communities who struggle with finding trusted, affordable help for everyday small tasks by providing a real-time, verified, hyperlocal micro-skill marketplace so that they can earn and access help daily with full trust and zero friction.

Value Proposition Breakdown

Element	TradeLoop Answer
WHO	Skilled workers and households in underserved communities (Khayelitsha Site C and similar informal settlements)
PROBLEM	Finding trusted, affordable, and immediately available help for everyday small tasks
SOLUTION	A real-time, verified, hyperlocal micro-skill marketplace (mobile app)
BENEFIT	Earn and access help daily with full trust, verified workers, and zero payment friction

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